

Topic 10: AI for Editing and Proofreading

10.1 AI Editing Tools

- Grammarly (grammarly.com): real-time grammar, spelling, clarity, tone, and engagement suggestions in any text field
- Hemingway Editor (hemingwayapp.com): highlights overly complex sentences, passive voice, adverbs, and readability issues
- ProWritingAid (prowritingaid.com): comprehensive analysis of style, consistency, cliches, and pacing for long documents
- ChatGPT / Claude: paste your draft and ask for specific feedback on structure, clarity, tone, or length
- Principle: use AI as a first-pass editor; apply your own judgement -- not every AI suggestion improves the piece

10.2 Targeted Editing Prompts

- Clarity: 'Rewrite this paragraph to be clearer. The reader has no background in [topic].'
- Concision: 'Cut this by 30% without losing any essential information.'
- Passive voice: 'Identify and rewrite all passive voice constructions in this text.'
- Consistency: 'Check this document for inconsistent terminology and suggest standardised alternatives.'
- Flow and transitions: 'Improve the transitions between these paragraphs so the piece reads more smoothly.'

Comprehensive edit prompt:

'Edit the following text for:

1. Grammar and spelling errors
2. Clarity -- flag any confusing sentences
3. Concision -- suggest specific cuts for wordiness
4. Tone consistency -- target: professional but approachable
5. Flow -- suggest improved transitions where needed

Return the edited version with brief notes on key changes made.

Text: [paste your draft here]'

10.3 Style and Voice Consistency

- House style: 'Apply our style rules throughout: serial comma, British spelling, numbers written out under ten, no contractions'

- Terminology audit: 'List every instance in this document where product names or key terms are used inconsistently'
- Voice check: 'Does this article sound like our brand? Here are two examples of our typical writing: [paste examples]'
- Tense and POV: 'This document mixes past and present tense. Standardise to present tense throughout.'

10.4 Proofreading Checklist

- Common checklist items: spelling, grammar, factual accuracy, formatting, consistent capitalisation, broken links
 - Prompt: 'Review this text against the following checklist and flag any issues: [paste checklist]'
 - Final human pass is always necessary -- AI misses context-dependent and relationship-based errors
 - Read-aloud test: using text-to-speech on the final draft catches errors your eyes habitually skip
 - For important content: two-pass review -- AI tool first, then a second human editor
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